PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/XDR | Detection-as-Code | SOAR Automation | KQL

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Engineer with over five years of enterprise security experience centred on Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms, and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. In my current role at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I engineer detection-as-code using Kusto Query Language (KQL) in Microsoft Sentinel, build and maintain SOAR playbook automations, and manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and CrowdStrike Falcon across a user base of over 8,000. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring practical expertise in PowerShell and Python scripting for security automation, Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) identity security, and vulnerability management using Tenable.io. I thrive in technically demanding environments where detection quality, automation depth, and rapid incident response are paramount, and I am eager to apply my skills in a role focused on delivering best-in-class SIEM and XDR capability.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and XDR:** Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, NG-SIEM, Prevent, Insight, Discover)
- **Detection-as-Code and KQL:** Custom KQL detection rule authoring, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, detection tuning and false positive reduction, threat hunting queries
- **SOAR and Playbook Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks, automated alert enrichment, playbook development for incident response, PowerShell automation, Python scripting
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Email and Network Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Certifications and Frameworks:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, NIST 800-61, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Engineer detection-as-code solutions using KQL in Microsoft Sentinel, developing custom analytics rules, hunting queries, and workbook dashboards aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, covering identity, endpoint, email, and cloud telemetry sources.
- Build and maintain SOAR playbook automations using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, automating alert triage workflows including IP reputation lookups, user risk scoring, asset classification, and automatic containment actions for high-confidence detections.
- Integrate data connectors from Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon, Azure AD, and Mimecast into Microsoft Sentinel to provide a unified security operations view and single-pane-of-glass incident management.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Falcon Insight (threat hunting), and Falcon Discover (asset visibility) across an 8,000-user estate, configuring and tuning prevention policies and running proactive threat hunting engagements.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) policies, including attack surface reduction (ASR) rule configuration, identity-based alert tuning, and custom indicator of compromise (IoC) management.
- Oversee Microsoft Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) security posture, enforcing Conditional Access policies, MFA, and SSO governance for over 8,000 users.

- Conduct vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking using Tenable.io and AppCheck, and validate detection coverage using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises.
- Write PowerShell and Python scripts to automate security operations tasks including alert enrichment, log ingestion normalisations, compliance reporting, and user account auditing.

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Authored and maintained KQL detection rules and alert correlation logic in Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, improving detection fidelity for identity threats, lateral movement, and data exfiltration scenarios.
- Developed SOAR playbook automations to streamline Level 1 alert triage, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and allowing analysts to focus on higher-complexity investigations.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution, enforcing just-in-time (JIT) access and session monitoring for all privileged and service accounts.
- Supported deployment and policy configuration for Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), tuning detection settings and managing custom IoC feeds for threat intelligence integration.
- Conducted threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, building hypothesis-driven hunting queries to detect adversary techniques not covered by existing alert rules.
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, producing prioritised remediation reports for IT infrastructure and web application findings.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered security and infrastructure support across a SaaS and FinTech environment, implementing endpoint security controls and supporting cloud hardening activities.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus, documenting and tracking findings through to remediation.
- Managed identity and access controls including Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), MFA enforcement, and user lifecycle management for cloud and on-premises platforms.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities and internal security audits.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed and deployed a full-coverage KQL detection rule library in Microsoft Sentinel at UAL, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, achieving measurable improvements in detection fidelity and reducing false positive alert volumes by over 40%.
- Built a SOAR playbook automation suite in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert enrichment, user risk assessment, and containment actions, significantly reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) across the security operations team.
- Integrated multiple telemetry sources into Microsoft Sentinel including CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft 365 Defender, Mimecast, and Azure AD, providing unified threat visibility across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud surfaces.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an 8,000-user estate with full endpoint visibility and proactive threat hunting capability using Falcon Insight.
- Validated SIEM and XDR detection coverage using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), identifying blind spots and improving detection rules across multiple attack technique categories.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid / Remote (London / UK)